

NETFLIX

Data Analysis Using Microsoft Excel

A case study on the Netflix catalogue dashboard

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Tool Used: Microsoft Excel

Dataset: Netflix Titles Dataset (Kaggle)

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Executive Summary

This case study presents a Microsoft Excel-based analysis of the Netflix catalogue. The dashboard, built using Pivot Tables and Pivot Charts, provides an interactive view of 8,277 titles, including 5,768 movies and 2,509 TV shows. Key findings show that Drama is the most common genre, the 18+ rating category represents the largest maturity segment, the United States dominates country-wise distribution, and content additions peaked in 2002.

- Total titles: 8,277 (Movies: 5,768; TV Shows: 2,509).
- Top genre: Drama (1,497 titles).
- Largest rating category: 18+ (3,730 titles, 45.1%).
- Leading country: United States (3,058 titles).
- Content additions peaked sharply in 2002.

Project Overview

Objective

To analyze Netflix's content library and identify trends in Movies and TV Shows using Microsoft Excel. The project builds an interactive dashboard that helps users understand content distribution by type, genre, rating, country, and release year through data visualization and KPI metrics.

Business Problem

Netflix's catalogue contains thousands of titles across multiple attributes. Without clear summarization, stakeholders cannot quickly see which content types, genres, ratings, and countries dominate the library. This project addresses the need for a single, interactive dashboard that summarizes the catalogue and supports fast, data-driven decision-making.

Dataset Description

The Netflix Titles Dataset (Kaggle) contains metadata for each title, including show_id, type (Movie or TV Show), title, director, country, date_added, release_year, rating, duration, and genre. The dashboard uses this data to produce KPIs, pivot tables, and visual summaries.

Project Facts:

Author: Kesika Reddy | Tool: Microsoft Excel | Dataset: Netflix Titles (Kaggle) | Total Titles: 8,277

Dashboard Overview

The dashboard is built in Microsoft Excel using a dark Netflix-themed canvas. It places five KPI cards at the top, slicers on the left, and four charts on the right. The screenshot below shows the exact layout used for analysis.



Figure 1: Netflix Catalogue Excel Dashboard

Dashboard Components:

KPI Cards • Top 10 Genres Bar Chart • Content by Rating Pie Chart • Top 10 Countries Table • Movies vs TV Shows Donut • Content Added by Year Line Chart • Slicers

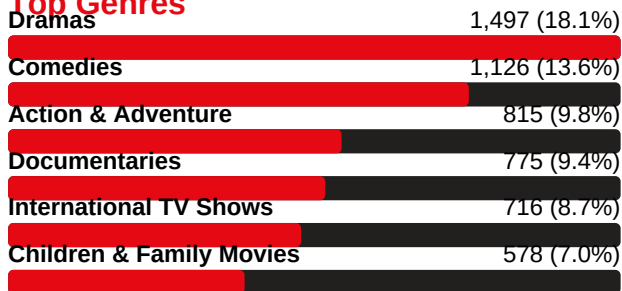
Business Insights

The following insights are based only on the values, charts, and filters visible in the dashboard. No external data or assumptions have been used.

Content by Rating Category



Top Genres



Key Findings

- Movies dominate the catalogue: 5,768 movies (69.7%) versus 2,509 TV shows (30.3%).
- Drama is the top genre with 1,497 titles, followed by Comedies (1,126) and Action & Adventure (815).
- The 18+ rating category is the largest segment at 3,730 titles (45.1%), indicating an adult-skewed library.
- Kids content accounts for 878 titles (10.6%), while Other ratings make up only 1.0%.
- The United States leads country distribution with 3,058 titles — more than three times the next country, India (946).
- India is heavily movie-oriented (871 movies vs. 75 shows), while Japan and South Korea are more TV-show oriented.
- The Content Added by Year line chart shows a sharp peak in 2002, with relatively low additions in surrounding years.

Methodology

Data Cleaning & Preparation

The raw Netflix Titles dataset was imported into Microsoft Excel and cleaned to ensure consistency. Missing or inconsistent values were handled, columns were formatted correctly, and derived fields such as year_added and RatingCategory were created to support analysis.

Pivot Tables

Pivot Tables were created to aggregate the data by key dimensions: type (Movie/TV Show), genre, rating category, country, and year added. These summaries provided the foundation for the dashboard KPIs and charts.

Pivot Charts

Pivot Charts were built from the Pivot Tables to visualize the data. The dashboard includes a bar chart for Top 10 Genres, a pie chart for Content by Rating Category, a donut chart for Movies vs TV Shows, and a line chart for Content Added by Year.

Dashboard Design

The dashboard was designed with a Netflix-inspired black, red, and white theme. KPI cards display headline metrics, slicers on the left allow interactive filtering by type, rating, and genre, and the charts are arranged for clear visual hierarchy and easy interpretation.

Workflow:

Import Dataset → Clean Data → Build Pivot Tables → Create Pivot Charts → Design KPI Cards → Add Slicers → Final Dashboard

Skills Demonstrated

This project demonstrates a practical end-to-end business intelligence workflow using Microsoft Excel. The following skills were applied throughout the project.



Microsoft Excel

Used for the entire project, including data cleaning, pivot tables, pivot charts, slicers, and dashboard layout.

Data Analysis

Identified patterns in content type, genre distribution, rating categories, and country-wise contributions.

Data Visualization

Created bar, pie, donut, and line charts to communicate findings clearly and effectively.

Dashboard Development

Built an interactive dashboard with KPI cards, slicers, and a consistent visual theme.

Business Intelligence

Translated raw data into actionable insights for content strategy and catalogue management.

Conclusion & Recommendations

Conclusion

The Netflix Data Analysis dashboard provides a clear, interactive summary of the Netflix catalogue. The analysis shows that the catalogue is movie-dominated, adult-oriented, and U.S.-centric, with Drama, Comedy, and Action & Adventure as the leading genres. The 2002 spike in content additions is a notable data characteristic that should be investigated before making operational decisions. Overall, the project demonstrates how Microsoft Excel can be used to build a professional business intelligence dashboard.

Recommendations

- Investigate the 2002 spike in content additions to confirm whether it represents a bulk data ingest or a genuine historical peak.
- Use the maturity mix (45.1% 18+, 10.6% Kids) as a baseline for content planning and parental control features.
- Compare U.S. content dominance against regional growth goals to identify gaps in international markets.
- Leverage the genre insights to prioritize content acquisition and commissioning for Drama, Comedy, and Action & Adventure.
- Extend the dashboard with additional filters such as release decade and duration to support deeper analysis.

About the Project

Created by Kesika Reddy using Microsoft Excel. Suitable for GitHub portfolio, LinkedIn showcase, and placement interviews.